

DOCUMENTATION OF LATILONG PAIR BIRD SIGHTING
FOR
THE COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS' RECORDS

A 56-91-83

Species: Purple Finch
(Vernacular name)

Carpodacus purpureus
(Scientific name)

If you watch birds solely for your own enjoyment, a written description of your observations is unnecessary. But, if you have seen something unusual, and would like to share this with others, a written description is essential. Compilers of regional bird lists must insist that their records be scientifically sound; future bird students--those studying occurrences 50 years from now--must have a written record on which to depend. By providing the verifying written description, you are employing a basic rule of the scientific method.

We recognize that experienced field observers can provide important and reliable records, if supported by an adequate verifying description. Thus this request is an effort to perpetuate your record by obtaining concrete evidence which may be permanently preserved for examination by others in the future. This procedure is required for every extraordinary observation, irrespective of the observer.

Date (s): March 3, 1991 Time Bird Seen: 9:15 to 9:25 AM

Locality: Colorado City, Pueblo County, Colorado - Purple Finch is not listed in latilong #26 Trinidad - in current latilong study
Nearest town, county and state: New latilong record

Optical equipment: 10x40 Zeiss Binocular

If photographed, please enclose copy. Equipment used: _____

Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: ♂ Male Plumage: Adult

Light conditions: Excellent

Distance from bird, and how measured: 30-40 feet estimated

Describe the bird's overall behavior:

During the entire observation the bird sat atop a tree and sang.

Describe the habitat in which you observed the bird:

Dense oak & cottonwood with lots of tangled understorey consisting of vines & shrubs. Elevation-6300 feet.

Other observers who independently identified this bird (Please list name and address):

Describe in great detail the bird which you saw. Emphasize particularly the field marks used to identify the bird, but include a complete description of the bird. Include size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern; details on shape or size of bill, wings, and tail. (Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions is not enough.) Describe what you actually saw in the field.

Overall gizz of bird was a somewhat top heavy appearance: large head, broad shoulders, and short notched tail. Bill was conical shape suggesting a grosbeak; bill was light grayish white colored. Head, throat, & nape were deep ruby-rose color. The color of the crown did not contrast with nape & throat. A light rose eyeline offered some contrast. Ruby-rose color extended into chest & upper belly but was lighter. Rosy splotted streaks on lower flanks & belly. Lower belly & undertail coverts were white & unstreaked. Ruby Rose color extended from head and nape into back. But the rose color became mixed with brown in the back giving back a chocolate cherry color. Wings were brown with light wing bars which were narrow & not prominent. Tail was dark brown & notched. Rump was bright rose colored contrasting with brownish rose back & brown tail.

Describe the bird's calls or sounds, if heard; including method of delivery-- i.e., from perch, in flight, etc.:

A long sweet warble with shorter notes & less harsh notes than a House Finch. The call seemed more rapid than both House & Cassin's Finch calls.

List similar species and how you eliminated them:

Male Cassin's Finch red crown contrasts with brown nape. Its crown is set off, whereas Rosy Finch's crown blends in more with Rosy nape face & throat. Its crown shows less contrast than Cassin's Finch. Rosy color does not extend as far down the chest & belly as Purple Finch which shows more rose color in throat, chest, & upper belly. Purple Finch's undertail coverts are also white & unmarked in contrast to Cassin's Finch streaked undertail coverts. Cassin's Finch has a more slender beak & has a more slender shape in contrast to the large headed, conical beak shape, & short tail of the more stocky purple Finch. House Finches have streaked underparts, more red-orange than of the more stocky purple Finch. House Finches have streaked underparts, more red-orange than of the more stocky purple Finch. House Finches have streaked underparts, more red-orange than of the more stocky purple Finch.

Prior experience with this and similar species: Rosy, and brown in head & nape.

I have seen many Cassin's & House Finches in Colorado. I have seen a few Purple Finch in Colorado but have seen many in Missouri, Illinois, & Maine.

This report was written from notes made during ___ after ___ observation; from memory ___.

NAME (print): David Silverman

Mailing address: P.O. Box 362 Rye CO 81069

Signature: David Silverman

Return Form To: CFO Records Committee
c/o Curator - Dept. of Zoological Collections
Denver Museum of Natural History
City Park
Denver, CO 80205

XC Hugh Kingery